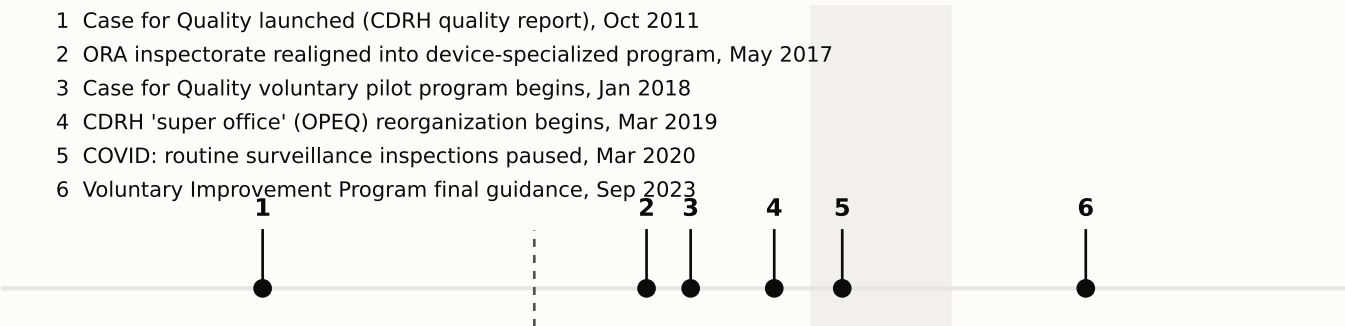
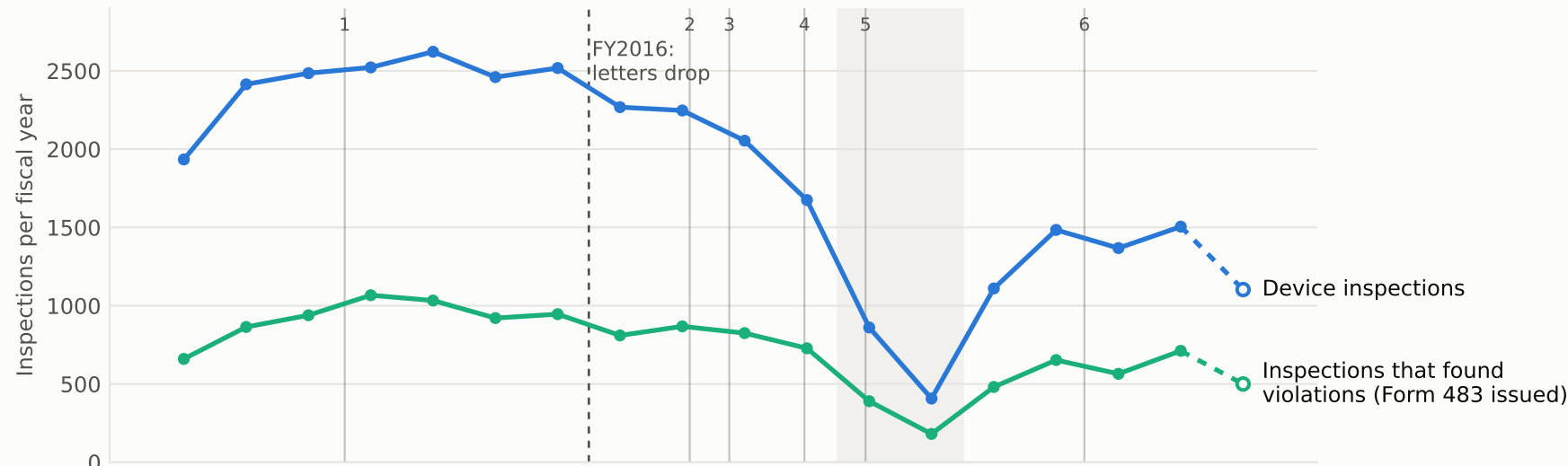


From FY2015 to FY2017, FDA device inspections dipped about 10%, but device warning letters fell 74% (167 to 44)

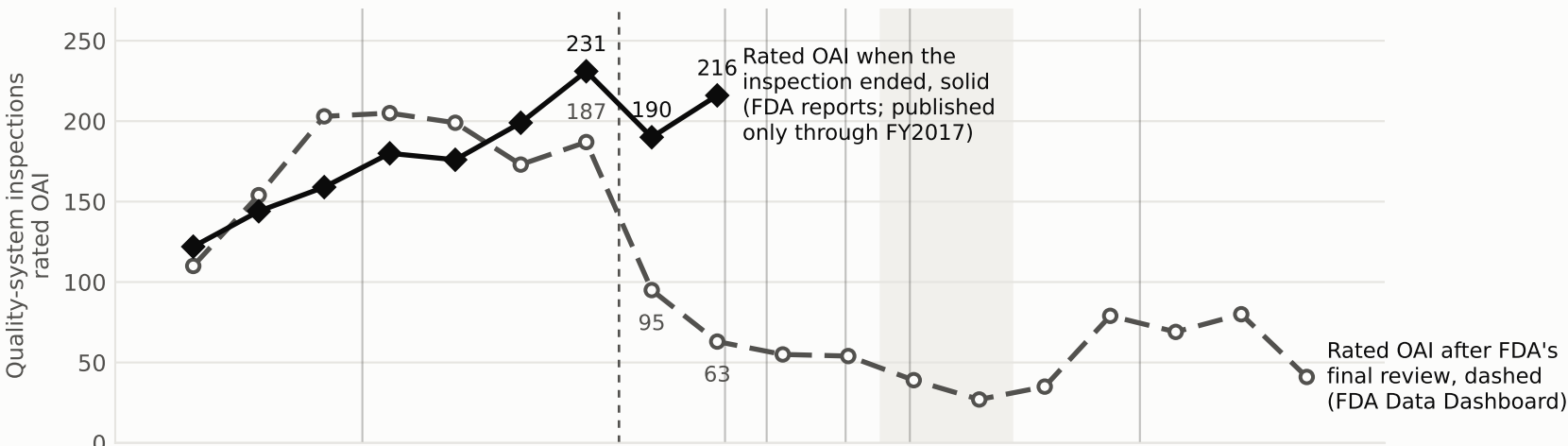
FDA device-quality program and organizational milestones



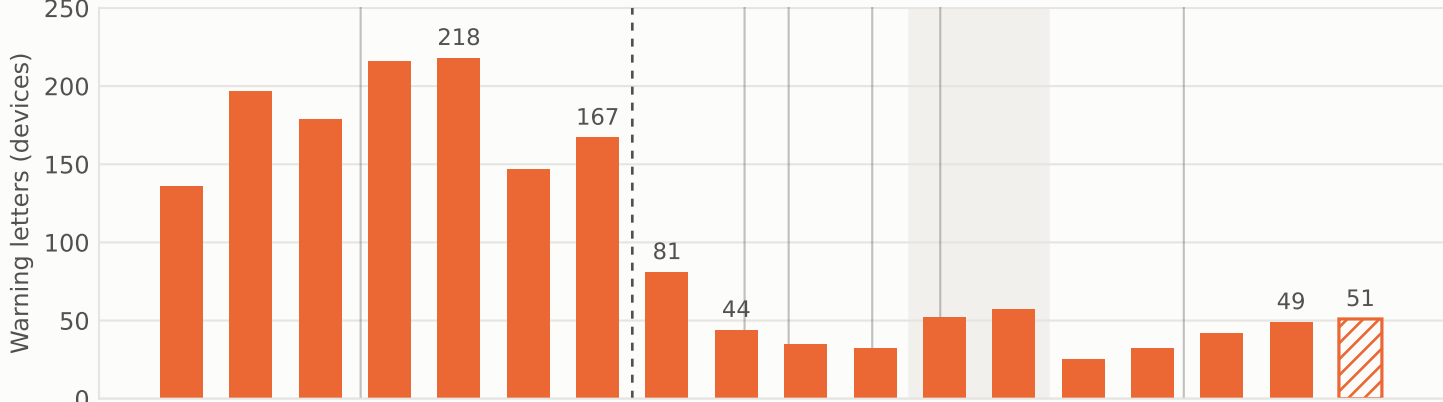
A. FDA kept inspecting device firms, and kept finding violations



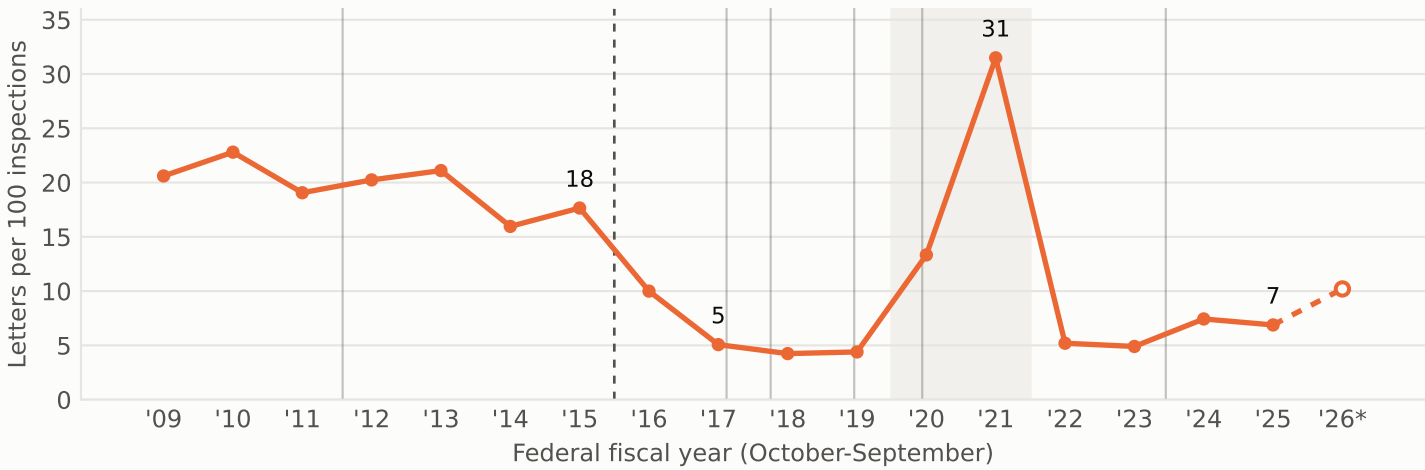
B. Serious violations (OAI) kept being found, but most were no longer finalized as OAI



C. And far fewer warning letters were issued



D. Warning letters per 100 inspections that found violations



Sources: FDA Data Dashboard (datadashboard.fda.gov), Inspections and Compliance Actions, product type Devices, accessed Sept 2026; warning letters counted once per FDA case number (all 1,760 letters, FY2009-FY2026).
*FY2026 is partial (letters through Sept 1, 2026; inspection classifications still being finalized): hatched / hollow.
Panel B: both lines count the same type of inspection, device quality-system (compliance) inspections. Solid: rated 'Official Action Indicated' when the inspection ended, from FDA/CDRH Medical Device Quality System Data reports (CY2009-2015 = inspections x reported OAI share, approximate; CY2016 and FY2017 reported counts; FDA stopped publishing after FY2017). Dashed: the same inspections' rating after FDA's final review (dashboard project area 'Compliance: Devices'; FY2015: 2,132 inspections vs 2,104 in FDA's report). The two agree through FY2015, then split. Some letters are not inspection-based (e.g., marketing violations), so panel D is an upper bound; FY2020-21 = COVID.
Milestones: FDA Case for Quality page and 'Understanding Barriers to Medical Device Quality' (Oct 31, 2011); ORA Program Alignment (May 15, 2017); Federal Register 2017-28044 (pilot Jan 2, 2018 - Dec 28, 2018); CDRH OPEQ reorganization (from March 2019); FDA inspection pause (March 2020); VIP final guidance (Sept 14, 2023).